Ford Motor Company

Service Recall Bulletin

August 2000

TO: All Ford and Lincoln Mercury Dealers

SUBJECT: **DEMONSTRATION / DELIVERY HOLD – Advance Announcement of Safety Recall 00S18:** Certain 2001 Model Year Escape Vehicles – Speed Control Cable and Servo Replacement

DEMONSTRATION / DELIVERY HOLD – Advance Announcement of Safety Recall 00S19: All 2001 Model Year Escape Vehicles – Steering Wheel Retention Quality Issue

UPDATE INFORMATION

This communication is forwarded to advise dealers that parts procurement is continuing on an expedited basis to support both Safety Recall programs. Service instructions have been completed and will be released with a complete dealer bulletin on Monday, August 14, 2000.

Parts will initially be sent to those dealers with 2001 model year Escape vehicles that have been delivered to customers. Due to the significance of the particular safety issues, dealers are strongly encouraged to contact owners of delivered units and request the return of the vehicles until repairs can be made.

AFFECTED VEHICLES

Safety Recall 00S18: Certain 2001 model year Escape vehicles equipped with V-6 engine and speed control, built at the Kansas City Assembly plant from October 22, 1999 through July 26, 2000.

Safety Recall 00S19: All 2001 model year Escape vehicles built at the Kansas City Assembly Plant from April 17, 2000 through July 26, 2000.

REASON FOR THIS DELIVERY HOLD ANNOUNCEMENT

Safety Recall 00S18: Affected vehicles are equipped with a speed control cable that may have a cracked or missing speed control cable servo cap locating tab. The potential exists for the locating tab to enter the servo clutch cavity and interfere with the speed control function.

Additionally, it is possible for water to enter those units that contain a cracked or missing servo cap locating tab. This water could eventually cause corrosion that could potentially interfere with the speed control function.

REASON FOR THIS DELIVERY HOLD ANNOUNCEMENT cont'd.

Either condition may possibly not allow the throttle to return to idle when disengaging the speed control. If the speed control is used and either of the above conditions are present, a stuck throttle could result, which could potentially lead to a vehicle crash.

Safety Recall 00S19: Affected vehicles are equipped with a steering wheel retention nut that may 1) be installed with an improper orientation or 2) have improper hardness characteristics. A steering wheel retention nut installed with the incorrect orientation may cause a fracture of the steering column shaft. A steering wheel retention nut with improper hardness characteristics may have fractured during the assembly process.

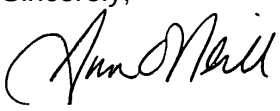
Either condition may possibly allow the steering wheel to separate from the steering column shaft. If steering wheel retention is compromised, loss of steering control could result, which could potentially lead to a vehicle crash.

Do not drive, demonstrate, deliver or perform pre-delivery inspection **on any vehicles affected by this recall until this repair has been performed.**

Federal law requires dealers to complete any outstanding safety recall service before a new vehicle is delivered to a buyer or lessee. Violation of this requirement by a dealer could result in a civil penalty of up to $ 1,100 per vehicle.

Affected vehicles are to be released from this hold only when the appropriate service repair has been completed.

Sincerely,



Ann O'Neill
Director
Vehicle Service and Programs